

OIL ANALYST

New Upside Price Risks Amid Red Sea Tensions

- We keep our 2026Q4 Brent forecast unchanged at \$80, assuming de-escalation by Q4, while highlighting new upside price risks.
- **New upside price risks.** Houthi claiming strikes on 2 tankers transiting through the Red Sea and another decline in Kazakhstan exports (Exhibit 4) amid Russia-Ukraine escalation further tilt risks to our near-term price forecast to the upside. Oil flows through the Bab-al-Mandab (BaM) Strait have averaged nearly 9mb/d over the past month, including nearly 4mb/d of BaM flows that might be difficult to re-route if Hormuz, BaM and Suez shipping frictions emerged together (Exhibit 1). Oil loadings at Saudi Arabia's Yanbu Red Sea port have remained stable over the past 7 days at around a high 5mb/d level (Exhibit 3).
- **Keeping our \$80 Brent forecast for 2026Q4.** Our unchanged baseline reflects price support from lower Mideast output in H2 (Exhibit 5), balanced by downside price pressure from stronger-than-expected Mideast output in June and weaker demand in China, South Korea, and the Mideast (Exhibit 6). We expect WTI to average \$76 in 2026Q4.
- **Summer tightening.** We expect prices to hold most of their recent gains through July and August as global (Exhibit 7) and OECD commercial stocks draw further for three reasons. First, Mideast production is likely to fall in July.¹ Second, demand should find support from summer travel (Exhibit 8). Third, OECD SPR net releases are slowing sharply after large Q2 draws, as South Korea and Japan are now replenishing (Exhibit 9).
- **Prices moderate in 2027 on surplus, assuming Hormuz is open.** We still expect 2027 Brent/WTI to average \$75/70 if Hormuz is open in 2027. We also maintain our 3.2mb/d 2027 average surplus assuming Hormuz is open (Exhibit 10), with production forecasts revised up for the UAE and down for Russia. Despite the large projected 2027 surplus, we don't expect Brent to fall below the high-\$60s because of 1.2mb/d of global strategic stockpiling in 2027 (Exhibit 11), and the price sensitivity of US shale (Exhibit 12) and of supply disruptions.
- **Net upside risks.** We see risks to our price forecast as tilted to the upside on net, especially in the near-term.

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¹ Assuming de-escalation in Q4, we assume Mideast production returns to its pre-war level around year-end, though continued tanker attacks could delay the rebound.

- **Price upside scenario:** Brent might exceed \$120/bbl in 2026Q4 and average \$100 in 2027 if Hormuz remains disrupted through 2027 ([Exhibit 13](#)), with further upside if BaM and Suez were also persistently disrupted.² Our price upside scenario assumes Gulf output only fully recovers by Dec27, supported by pipeline extensions.
- **Price downside scenario:** Brent might decline to the low \$60s by end-2027 if supply exceeds our expectations and demand losses prove more persistent.
- **Hedging escalation with diesel length.** We still recommend that investors and consumers seeking to hedge persistent geopolitical shocks in the Mideast and Russia go long the Dec26-March27 European diesel (“gasoil”) timespread.

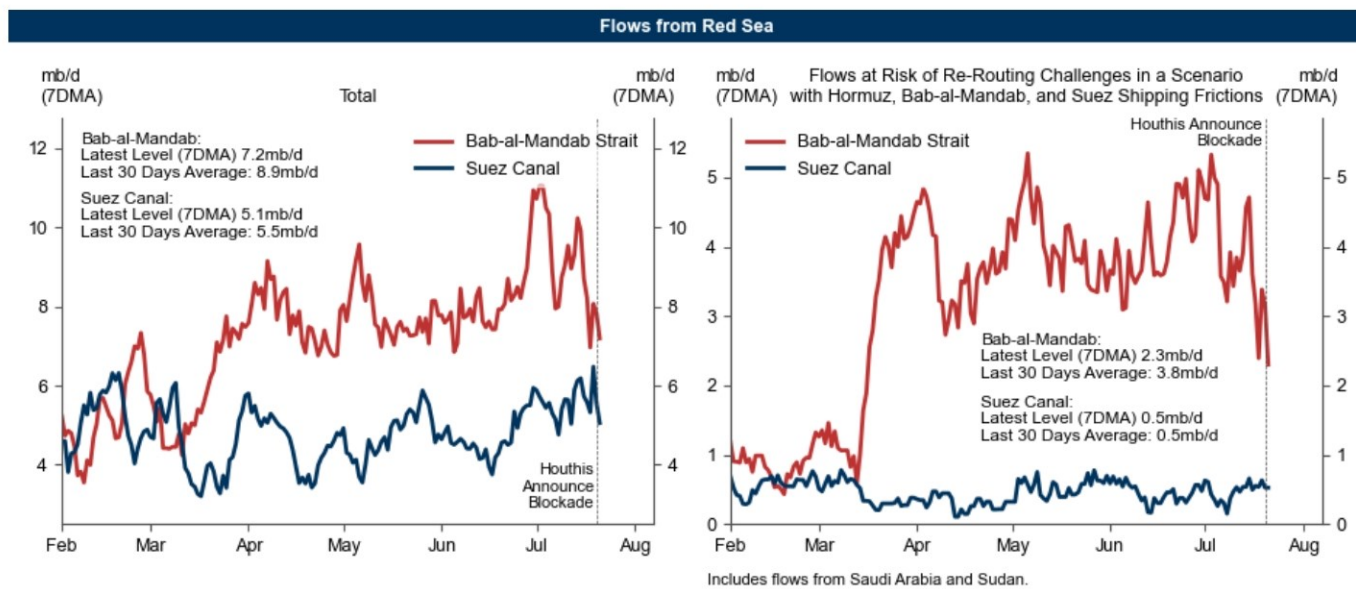
² Assuming shipping disruptions persist through 2027 in Hormuz, BaM, and Suez, we estimate an additional \$25 of upside to prices relative to our price upside scenario.

New Upside Price Risks Amid Red Sea Tensions

New Upside Price Risks

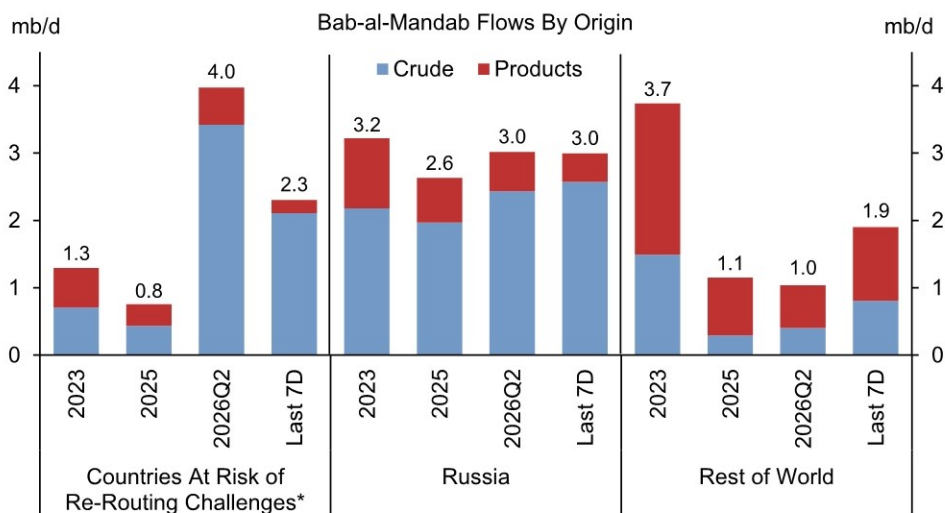
Risks to Red Sea Exports

Exhibit 1: Oil Exports via the Bab-al-Mandab Strait (BaM) Have Averaged Nearly 9mb/d Over the Past 30 Days, With a Nearly 4mb/d Contribution From BaM Flows That Might Face Re-Routing Challenges in a Scenario with Hormuz, BaM and Suez Shipping Frictions



Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

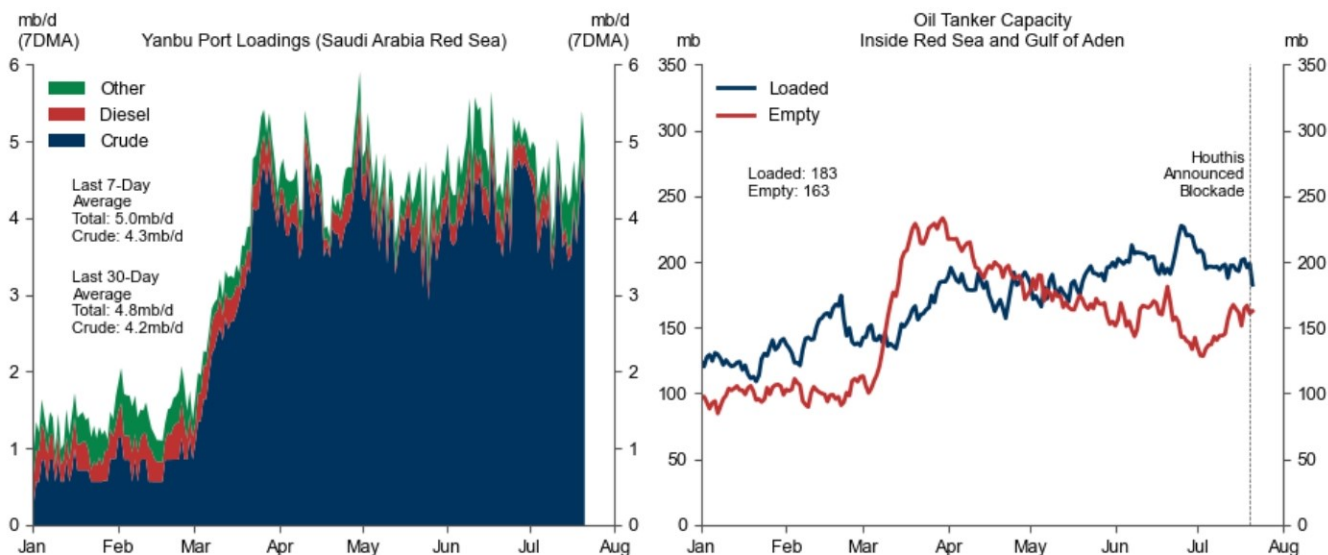
Exhibit 2: Combined Oil Flows From Saudi Arabia and Sudan via Bab-al-Mandab Rose to 4mb/d in 2026Q2 (Amid Redirection Mostly via the East-West Pipeline and the Yanbu Port)



*In a scenario with Hormuz, Bab-al-Mandab, and Suez shipping frictions; includes Saudi Arabia and Sudan.

Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

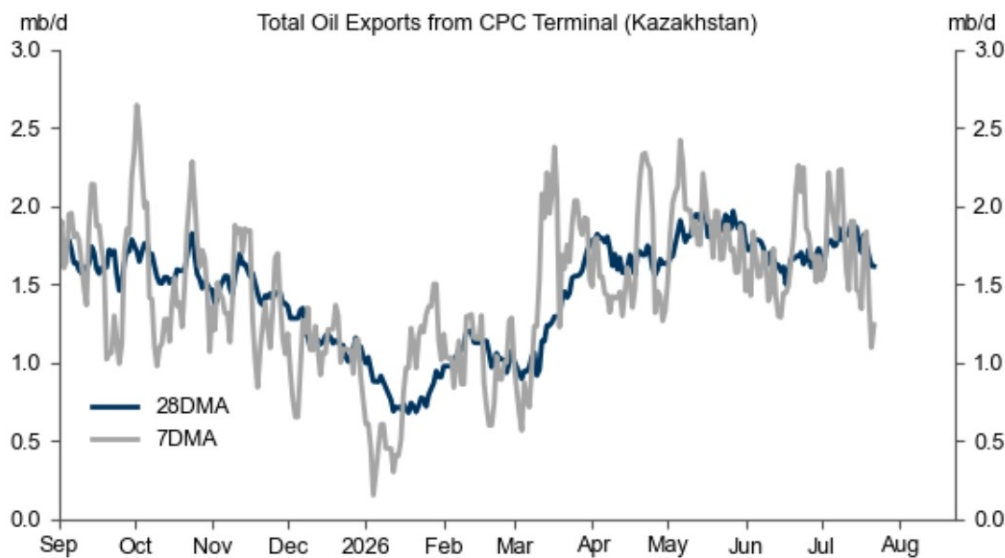
Exhibit 3: Despite Headlines Regarding Frictions, Oil Loadings at the Saudi Yanbu Port Have Remained Stable Over the Past 7 Days Around 5mb/d; Tanker Capacity Inside the Red Sea Has Not Changed Sharply Recently



Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Risks to Kazakhstan Exports

Exhibit 4: CPC Oil Exports Appear to Decline Following Strikes Amid Russia-Ukraine Escalation



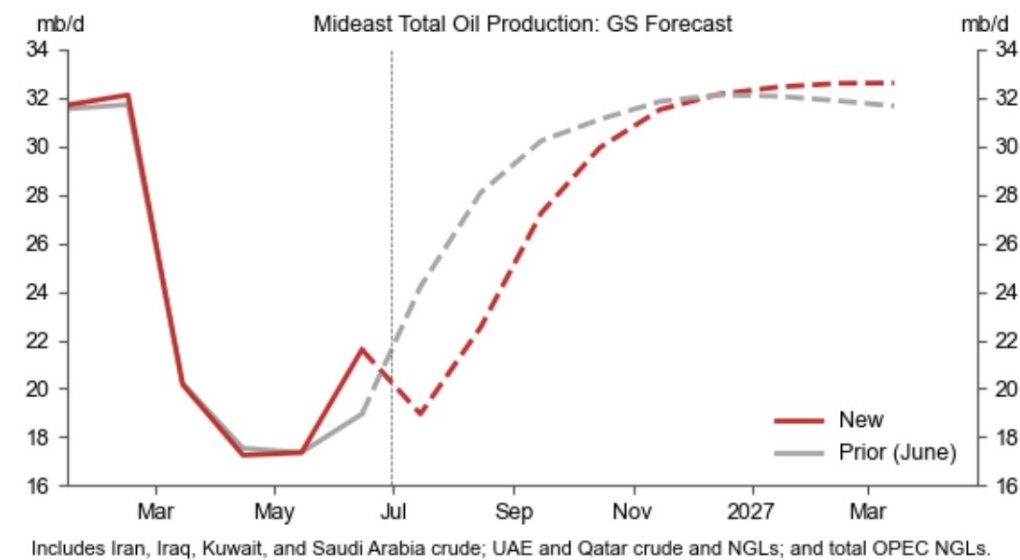
The Caspian Pipeline Consortium (CPC) transports Kazakh and Russian oil to Russia's Novorossiysk port, from where it is exported to the rest of the world. The CPC Terminal is the loading point at the port for this oil.

Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Keeping Our \$80 Brent Forecast for 2026Q4 (Assuming Q4

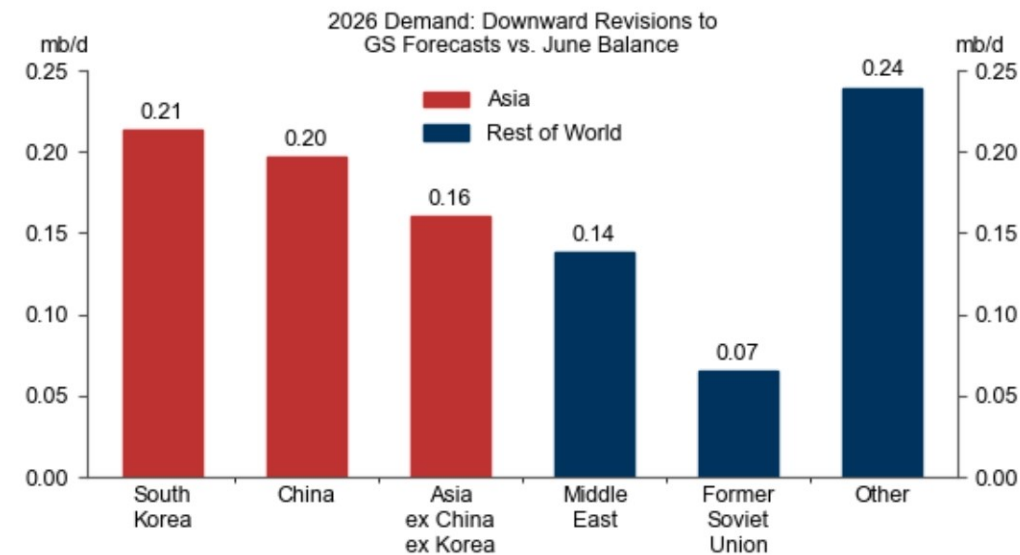
De-Escalation)

Exhibit 5: While Mideast Output Exceeded Our Expectations in June, Renewed Escalation Delays the Recovery in 2026H2



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: We Downgrade 2026 Demand in China, South Korea, and the Mideast, Mostly Reflecting Weak Realized Data



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Summer Tightening

Exhibit 7: Global Visible Oil Stocks Have Reached a Year-To-Date Low

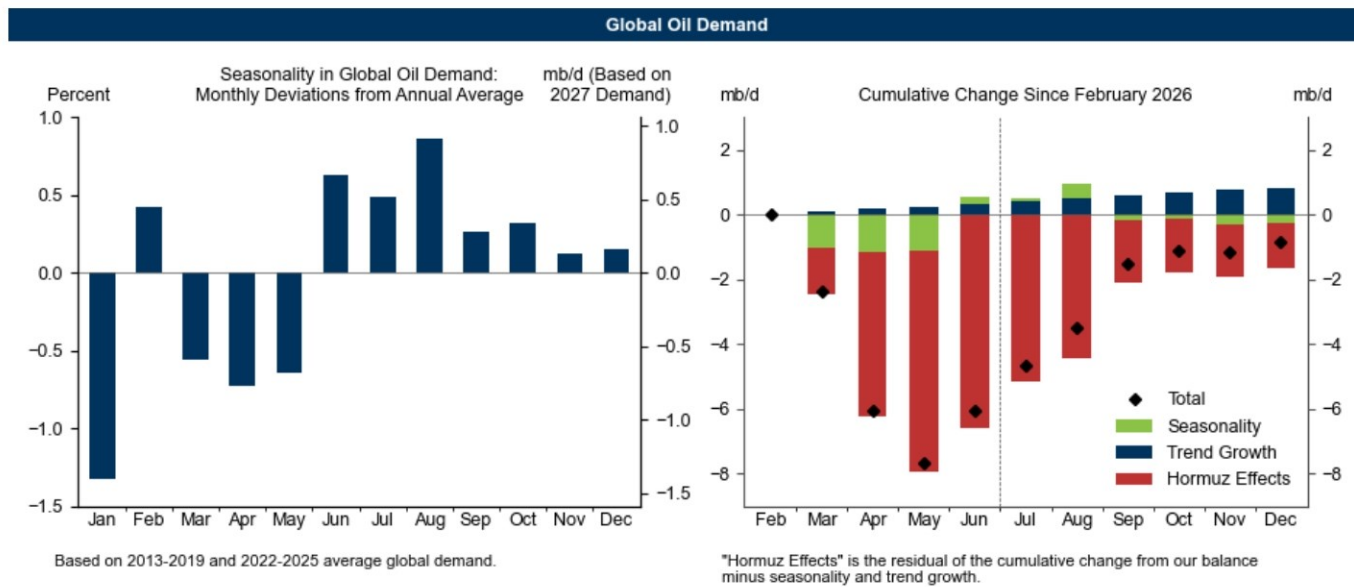


Source: IEA, Kpler, DOE, Euroilstocks, ARA PJK, PAJ, Haver, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Tightening Factor 1: Mideast Supply Declines in July

Tightening Factor 2: Demand Rebounds

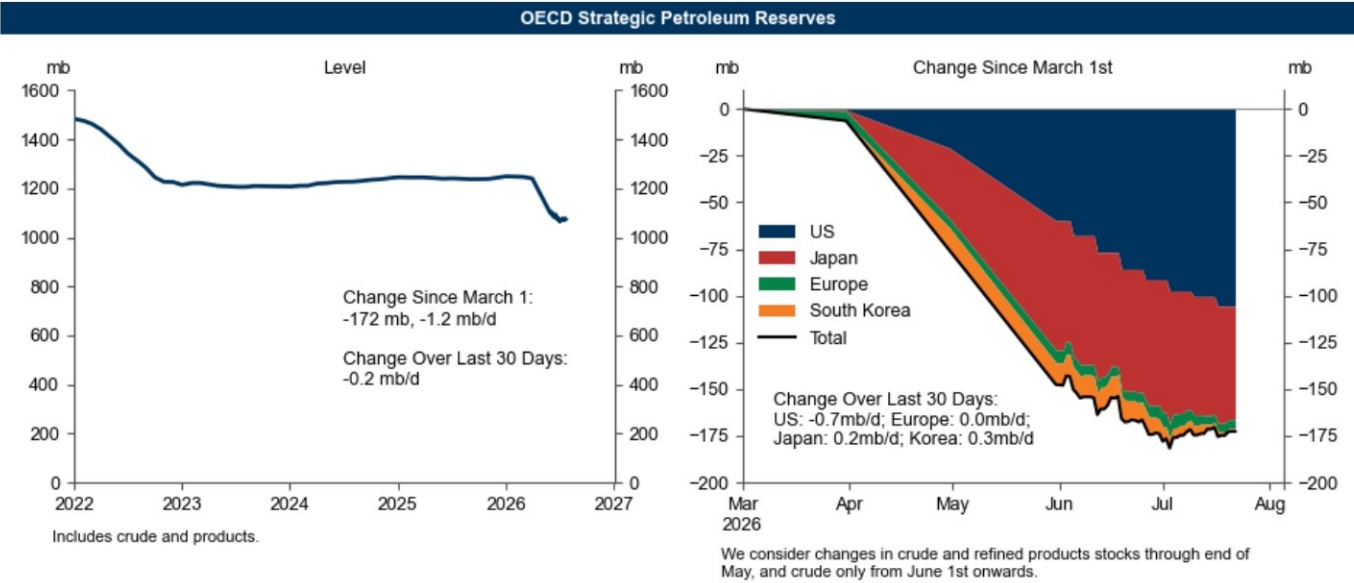
Exhibit 8: Summer Seasonality Should Boost Global Oil Demand by 0.8mb/d in Q3 vs Q2



Source: IEA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Tightening Factor 3: SPR Releases Have Slowed Sharply

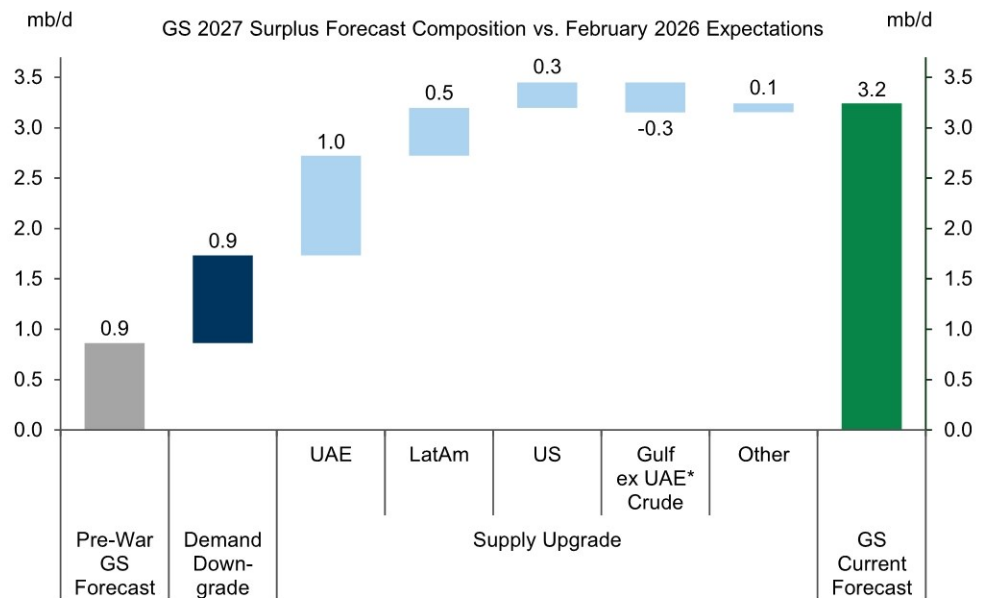
Exhibit 9: OECD SPR Net Releases Have Slowed Sharply Over the Past 30 Days After Large Q2 Draws as South Korea and Japan Are Now Replenishing



Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Prices Moderate in 2027 on Surplus

Exhibit 10: Assuming Hormuz Is Open in 2027, We Project a Larger 2027 Surplus of 3.2mb/d vs. Our Pre-War Expectations on Lower Global Demand, Higher UAE Output, and Strong Delivery in Latin America

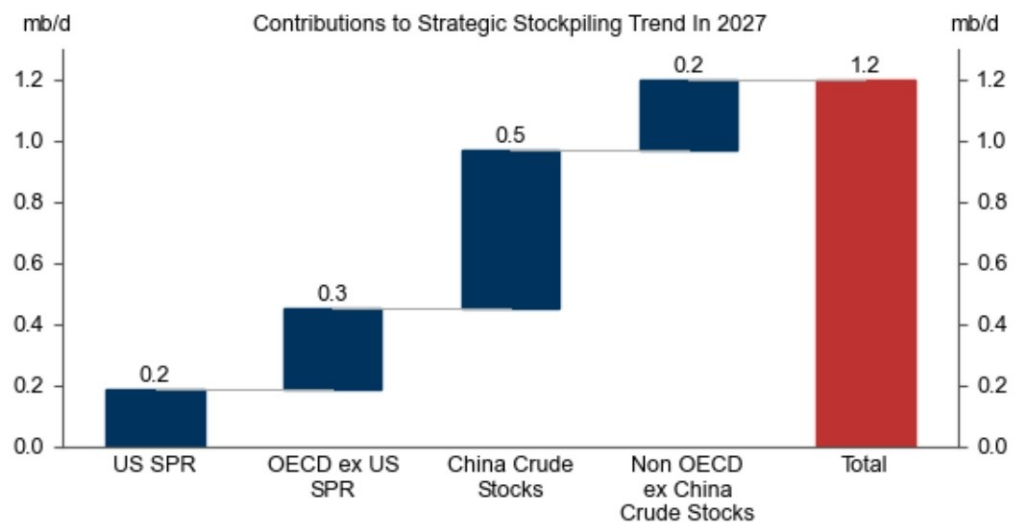


*Defined as Saudi Arabia, Iran, Iraq, Kuwait.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

New Floors

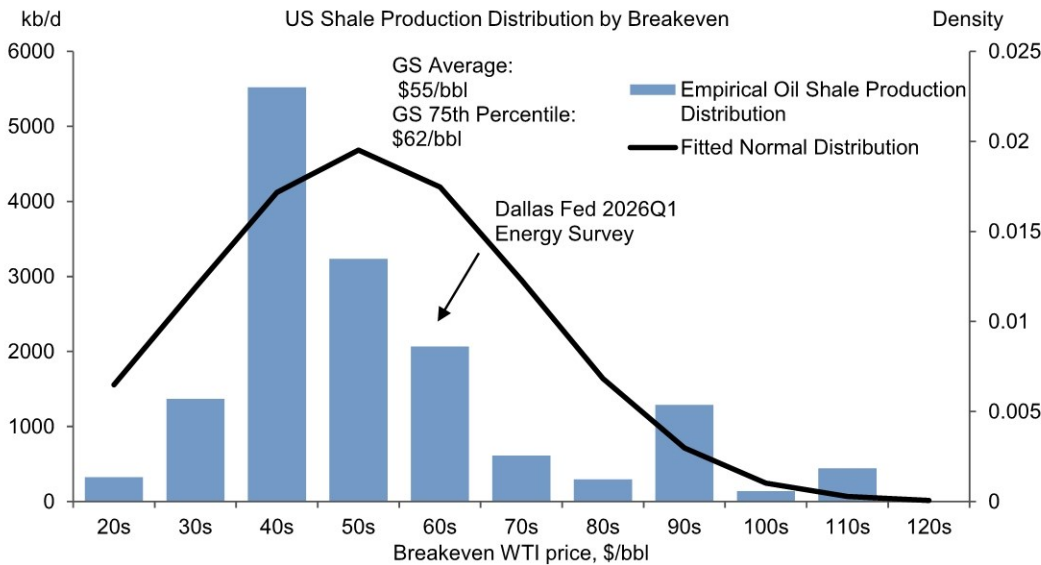
Exhibit 11: We See Global Strategic Stockpiling at 1.2mb/d in 2027



Includes visible and invisible stockpiling. OECD ex US SPR contains both crude and refined products..

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

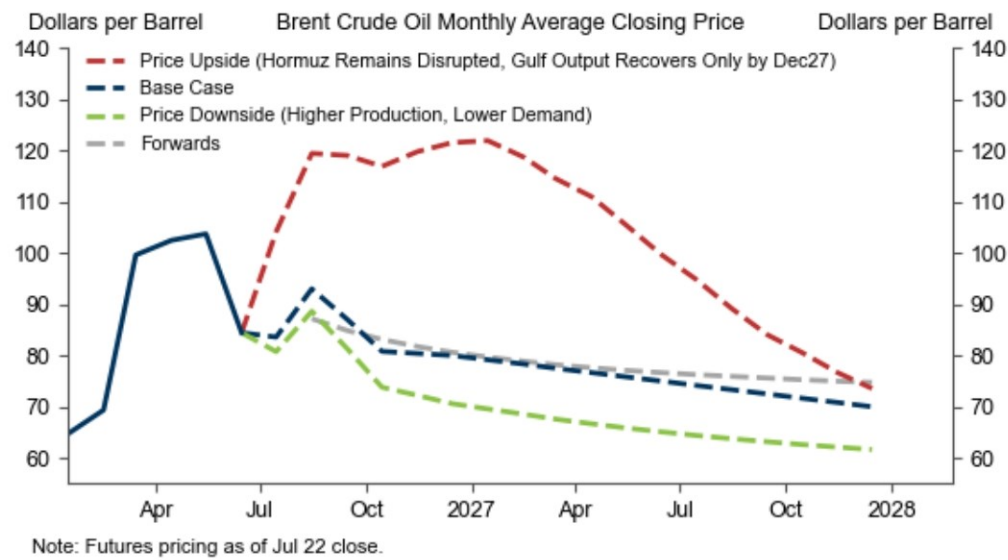
Exhibit 12: US Shale Production Will Likely Slow Materially if Crude Prices Were to Fall Persistently Below \$60/bbl



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Net Upside Risks to Prices, Especially in the Near-Term

Exhibit 13: Brent Might Exceed \$120/bbl in 2026Q4 and Average \$100 in 2027 If Hormuz Remains Disrupted Through 2027



Source: IC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Appendix

Exhibit 14: We Expect a Large 2.1mb/d Global Deficit in 2026Q3

GS 2025-2027 Oil Supply and Demand Outlook (mb/d)								Quarterly Levels							
	2025		2026		2027			2026				2027			
	Level	YoY	Level	YoY	Level	YoY		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
World Supply	105.9	3.2	102.1	-3.8	109.0	6.9		103.5	95.8	100.4	108.7	109.1	109.2	109.0	108.7
Non-OPEC ex. Russia Supply	65.8	2.0	66.7	0.8	68.4	1.8		65.3	65.1	67.3	69.0	68.3	68.6	68.5	68.4
Total US	22.3	0.8	23.1	0.7	23.3	0.2		22.5	23.2	23.3	23.3	23.0	23.6	23.4	23.3
Canada	6.4	0.3	6.5	0.1	6.5	0.0		6.5	6.3	6.5	6.6	6.6	6.3	6.5	6.6
Non-OPEC LatAm	7.0	0.6	7.9	0.8	8.1	0.3		7.6	7.9	8.0	8.0	8.0	8.0	8.2	8.3
UAE Liquids	4.3	0.2	4.5	0.2	5.6	1.1		4.0	3.5	5.0	5.4	5.5	5.6	5.7	5.7
Russia	10.4	-0.2	10.3	-0.1	9.7	-0.6		10.4	10.4	10.4	10.1	10.0	9.8	9.7	9.5
OPEC Supply	29.6	1.3	25.1	-4.5	30.8	5.7		27.8	20.3	22.7	29.6	30.8	30.8	30.9	30.8
Saudi Crude	9.4	0.5	8.5	-1.0	10.5	2.0		9.3	6.7	7.7	10.1	10.5	10.5	10.5	10.5
OPEC Liquids ex. Saudi Crude	20.2	0.9	16.6	-3.6	20.4	3.7		18.4	13.6	15.0	19.4	20.3	20.4	20.4	20.4
World Demand	104.5	0.8	102.6	-1.8	105.8	3.1		104.3	99.1	102.5	104.7	104.8	105.0	106.6	106.7
OECD Demand	45.9	0.0	45.4	-0.4	45.8	0.4		45.8	44.0	45.9	46.1	45.8	45.1	46.4	46.0
US	20.7	0.2	21.0	0.2	21.0	0.0		20.8	20.9	21.1	21.0	20.9	20.9	21.2	21.1
OECD Europe	13.4	0.0	13.2	-0.2	13.2	0.0		12.9	12.9	13.8	13.4	13.0	13.1	13.7	13.1
Non-OECD Demand	58.6	0.8	57.2	-1.4	60.0	2.8		58.6	55.1	56.5	58.5	59.0	59.9	60.2	60.7
China	16.9	0.2	16.1	-0.8	16.4	0.3		17.1	15.2	15.7	16.3	16.5	16.5	16.4	16.4
India	5.9	0.1	5.8	-0.1	6.5	0.6		6.1	5.7	5.4	6.1	6.5	6.6	6.2	6.6
Other Non-OECD Asia	9.4	0.2	9.4	0.0	10.0	0.6		9.6	9.1	9.3	9.7	9.9	10.0	10.0	10.1
Imbalance (=Supply-Demand)	1.4	2.4	-0.6	-2.0	3.2	3.8		-0.9	-3.3	-2.1	4.0	4.2	4.2	2.4	2.1
Change in OECD Comm. Stocks	0.2	-	-0.2	-	0.6	-		-0.3	-0.9	-0.3	0.6	0.6	0.9	0.4	0.3

The "delta" column corresponds to revisions to the levels vs. our prior June balance.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: We Keep Our Brent Price Forecasts at \$80 in 2026Q4 and \$75 in 2027

	Brent (\$/bbl)			WTI (\$/bbl)		
	New GS Forecast	Old GS Forecast	Forwards (Nearby Contract Traded That Month)	New GS Forecast	Old GS Forecast	Forwards (Nearby Contract Traded That Month)
2025	68	68		65	65	
2026	86	85	87	81	80	81
2027	75	75	77	70	70	72
2028	71	71	73	66	66	69
2029	74	74	72	69	69	67
2030	75	75	71	70	70	65
2031-2035	75	75	69	70	70	62
1Q26	78	78	78	72	72	72
2Q26	97	97	97	93	93	93
3Q26	88	84	90	83	79	84
4Q26	80	80	83	76	75	77
1Q27	78	78	80	73	74	74
2Q27	76	76	78	71	71	72
3Q27	73	73	76	68	69	71
4Q27	71	71	75	66	66	70
Jan-26	65	65		60	60	
Feb-26	69	69		65	65	
Mar-26	100	100		91	91	
Apr-26	102	102		98	98	
May-26	104	104		99	99	
Jun-26	84	84		82	82	
Jul-26	84	86		80	81	
Aug-26	93	84	90	87	79	84
Sep-26	87	83	87	82	77	81
Oct-26	81	81	85	77	76	79
Nov-26	80	80	83	76	75	77
Dec-26	80	80	82	75	75	76
Jan-27	79	79	81	74	74	75
Feb-27	78	78	80	73	74	74
Mar-27	78	77	79	73	73	73
Apr-27	77	77	78	72	72	73
May-27	76	76	78	71	71	72
Jun-27	75	75	77	70	70	72
Jul-27	74	74	77	69	70	71
Aug-27	73	73	76	68	69	71
Sep-27	73	72	76	68	68	71
Oct-27	72	72	76	67	67	70
Nov-27	71	71	75	66	66	70
Dec-27	70	70	75	65	65	70

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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